

Literature • Fable

Grade	1	Word Count	213
Lexile	470L	Multi-level	N/A
Learning A–Z	level H		

Refer to the Focus Question on page 2 of this title to guide discussion and support additional learning connected to the text.

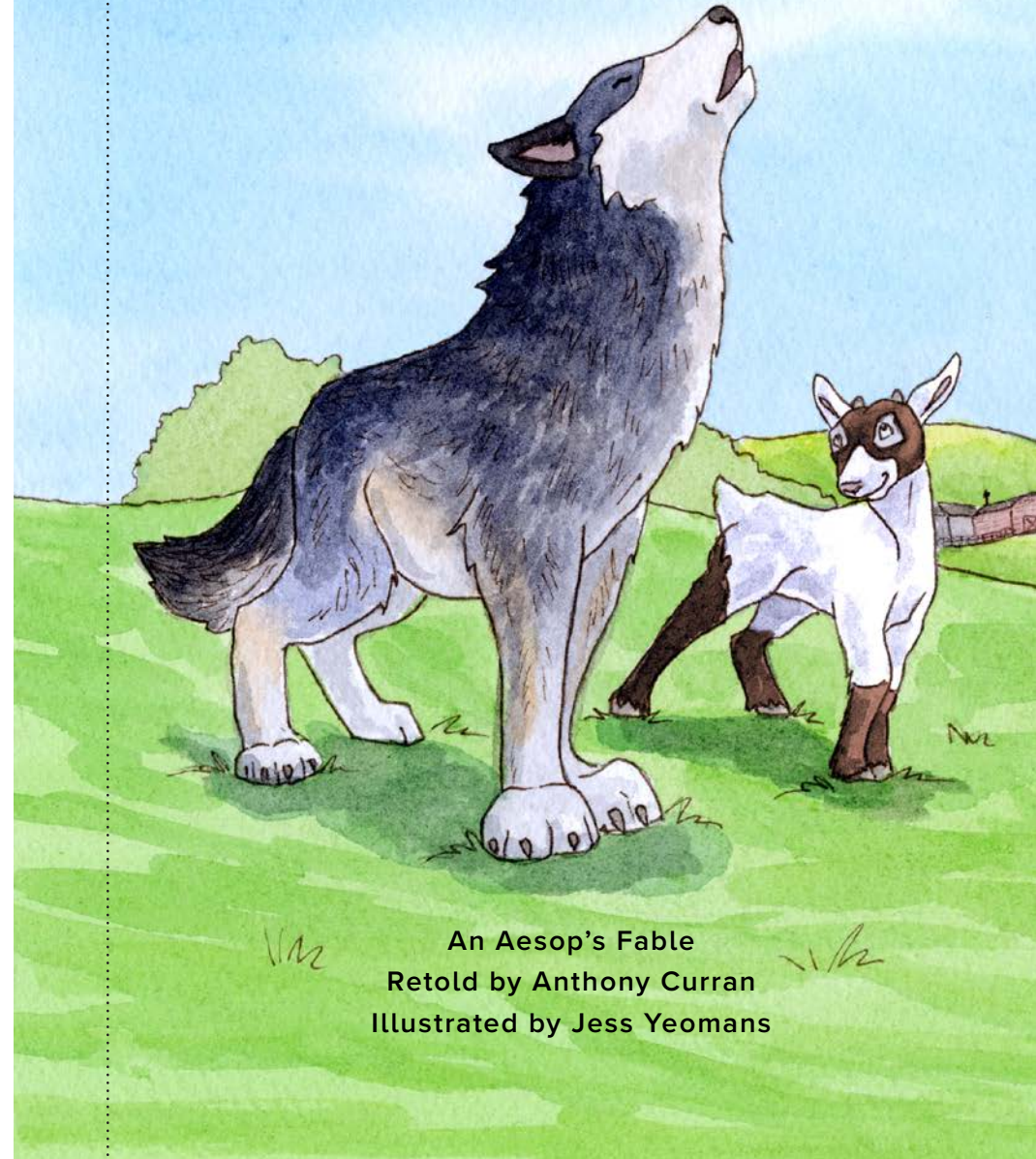
A young goat is startled when a wolf jumps out of the bushes. The wolf chases the goat and wants to eat him. Unfortunately for the wolf, the goat is very clever and thinks of a plan to fool the wolf. Will he succeed in his task, or will he become the wolf's dinner? Young readers will enjoy reading to find the outcome of this ancient Greek fable!


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The Goat and the Singing Wolf



An Aesop's Fable
Retold by Anthony Curran
Illustrated by Jess Yeomans

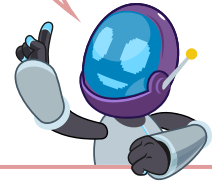
The Goat and the Singing Wolf



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Focus Question

Why is it important to
stay focused when working
toward a goal?



Words to Know

begged	favor
caught	goal
distracted	howl



A young goat was walking
across a field.
Suddenly, a hungry wolf jumped
out of the bushes.



The goat ran for his life, but the
wolf soon **caught** him.



The hungry wolf licked his lips.
He opened his jaws to eat the goat.



“Wait!” cried the goat before
the wolf could gobble him up.
“Do me one **favor** before you eat
me!” he **begged**.



“What favor is that?” asked the wolf.

“It’s a small thing, really,” said the goat.



“I want to hear music once more in my life,” said the goat.

“Would you please sing me a song before you eat me?” he asked.



The wolf thought for a moment.
“Why not?” he laughed.
“I can still eat you when I am done
singing,” the wolf growled.



So the wolf began to **howl** out
a song for the goat.
His mighty voice was loud
and strong.



A pack of dogs lived nearby
on a farm.



The wolf's howls soon brought the
farmer's dogs running.



The pack of dogs quickly chased off the wolf.



The young goat laughed when he saw the wolf run away.
“That was the best song I ever heard!” he chuckled.



The wolf learned an important lesson that day.
Do not become **distracted** when a **goal** is within reach.

Glossary

begged (*v.*) page 6

asked in an emotional way for something

caught (*v.*) page 4

grabbed and held something

distracted (*adj.*) page 15

unfocused or unable to pay attention to something

favor (*n.*) page 6

a special act of kindness

goal (*n.*) page 15

something that one is trying to do or accomplish

howl (*v.*) page 10

to make a long, loud cry